

GOOD ATTITUDES = GREAT OUTCOMES

TEXT: Numbers 14:24 (NKJV) “*But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me fully, I will bring into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it.*”

INTRO: In our text, we are introduced to one of the Bible’s most prolific and successful characters, Caleb. One of the greatest compliments in the Word of God is paid to this little known Old Testament character. Numbers 14:24 (NKJV) “*But My servant Caleb, because he has a different spirit in him and has followed Me fully, I will bring into the land where he went, and his descendants shall inherit it.*”

Caleb had a good spirit about him. Caleb exhibited a great attitude in a difficult situation. He had a spirit of:

- Composure...

- Conquest...
- Confidence...
- Conviction...

I. CALEB EXHIBITED AS ATTITUDE OF COMPOSURE...

Caleb was an ordinary man who **CHOSE** to live his life in the lane of an extraordinary purpose.

As far as men go, Caleb would probably not have stood out in the crowd. His name could have been Smith, Jones, or Harris; he was an ordinary sort of a guy. What set Caleb apart were his attitude when confronted with difficulty. The Bible declared that ***“He had another spirit from the Lord...”***

In order for us who are in this room today to take a step from the arena of the ordinary to the world of the extraordinary, it will take

the same things that Caleb had to assimilate into his life.

Caleb was ready to take on a challenge at a moments notice and do it with an attitude of composure. No matter what the crisis, even in the midst of an evil report, Caleb's attitude was, "*This to will turn to good.*" Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Caleb was expressing faith when the tide of public opinion was diametrically opposed to his point of view. A poll was taken by Moses, and 83.33% of the people were saying just the opposite of what Caleb had in mind. He was outnumbered 5 to 1! Caleb did not allow the tide of public opinion to determine his faith, he knew God was able to deliver and he was ready to do his part in the battle. Bad attitudes = Bad outcomes!

Caleb was surrounded by negativity. When things in our whirlwind become negative it

is easy to just be sucked into the vacuum created by the whirlwind. This is not the case with Caleb, when others are stating the reasons why it would be impossible for Israel to prevail; he made unwavering declarations of faith in Israel and Israel's God! Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Notice Numbers 13:26-30 (NKJV) ***“Now they departed and came back to Moses and Aaron and all the congregation of the children of Israel in the Wilderness of Paran, at Kadesh; they brought back word to them and to all the congregation, and showed them the fruit of the land. 27 Then they told him, and said: "We went to the land where you sent us. It truly flows with milk and honey, and this is its fruit. 28 Nevertheless the people who dwell in the land are strong; the cities are fortified and very large; moreover we saw the descendants of Anak there. 29 The Amalekites dwell in the land of the South;***

the Hittites, the Jebusites, and the Amorites dwell in the mountains; and the Canaanites dwell by the sea and along the banks of the Jordan." Bad attitudes = Bad outcomes! *"30 Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, "Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it."* Caleb said SHHHH!!!!!!

If we hope to demonstrate a spirit of composure in a faithless situation we must get our eyes off of the circumstances and get them on the final outcome!

If we keep our eyes on the finish line and the Lord we can remain calm cool and collected no matter how difficult the situation becomes. We are not under the circumstances, but we've got a God who is God in spite of the circumstances! Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

David said in Psalms 61:1-3 (NKJV) ***“To the Chief Musician. On a stringed instrument. A Psalm of David. Hear my cry, O God; Attend to my prayer. 2 From the end of the earth I will cry to You, When my heart is overwhelmed; Lead me to the rock that is higher than I. 3 For You have been a shelter for me, A strong tower from the enemy.”***

In Caleb’s case there were 10 grasshoppers and two giant killers! The difference between grasshoppers and giant killers is the ability to have a good attitude in difficult times. This can only be achieved through a spirit of composure!

Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

II. CALEB EXHIBITED AN ATTITUDE OF CONQUEST...

Notice the words of Caleb, Numbers 13:30 (NKJV) ***“Then Caleb quieted the people***

before Moses, and said, "Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it."

There's a time to pray, and a time to act! It is easy to get into the stall mode using the excuse; we are praying about it. (There are some things you don't have to pray about!)

A failure to properly discern whether it is time to pray or time to act can be costly. In this case I believe Israel could have achieved victory if they had just taken the advice of Caleb, closed the discussion and began the process of dividing and conquering the land!

The majority of the leadership of Israel wanted something-for-nothing! They had lived as slaves for more than four hundred years; because of this; they did not know how to achieve one thing that was not being

handed to them. Bad attitudes = Bad outcomes!

If we are not constantly on our guard we can very easily fall into the trap of living in the same kind of slave mentality that kept Israel from the Promised Land. If a thing is being freely offered without any challenge, we are willing to accept it. However, if effort is required on our part, we seem to lose our courage. Bad attitudes = Bad outcomes!

The things worth having in life require a price to be paid!

- Career...
- Marriage...
- Parenthood...
- Spiritual walk...

If we are not willing to pay the price, we will probably never be in possession of the things we most desire. If we in fact achieve them there will very likely be a price to pay!

Those who have a spirit of conquest are willing to pay the price and persevere when the going gets tough! They are willing to move out in obedience to God through faith! Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Everything about this man Caleb portrays the fact he is a fiery soldier, summoned to a conquest, and guided to a glorious, victorious destiny! Even though he had a spirit of conquest and believed he could conquer his inheritance did not mean the going would be easy! He still had forty plus years of faithful endurance and staying in shape for battle, ahead of him. Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Those who have a spirit of conquest put their own personal likes and dislikes on the back burner because they realize there is a greater destiny to be achieved.

Notice this; for more than forty years we don't hear one negative word from Caleb about the other 10 guys! He didn't have time to get caught up in that; he had a mountain to conquer! Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

III. CALEB EXHIBITED AN ATTITUDE OF CONFIDENCE...

Numbers 13:30 (NKJV) ***"Then Caleb quieted the people before Moses, and said, 'Let us go up at once and take possession, for we are well able to overcome it.'"***

Notice with me, Caleb's confidence is not blind! He has seen the same giants all the others have seen! It is imperative that anyone who is going to fight this good fight of the Faith keep his or her eyes open, and learn to properly evaluate the challenges that lie ahead. 1 Peter 5:8 (NKJV) ***"Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil***

walks about like a roaring lion, seeking whom he may devour.”

The difference between the 10 grasshoppers and the two giant killers is that in spite of what they were facing, the two giant killers decided to have an attitude of confidence toward God! Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Caleb’s attitude was an attitude of confidence rather than one of denial! You can deny your circumstance or face it in confidence! Hebrews 10:35 (NKJV)

“Therefore do not cast away your confidence, which has great reward.”

Caleb did not deny there were monumental obstacles, but his confidence said, “*Even though...*” Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

How could Caleb have such confidence in the face of such overwhelming adversity? Caleb knew that if God had promised them the land (And He had) that God would deliver on His promise, no matter how impossible it seemed! Good attitudes = Great outcomes! Zechariah 4:6 (NKJV) ***“So he answered and said to me: ‘This is the word of the LORD to Zerubbabel: ‘Not by might nor by power, but by My Spirit,’ Says the LORD of hosts.’”***

Would the task of conquering the land be difficult because of the giants? Yes! Would the task of conquering the land be impossible because of the giants? No! Mark 9:23 (NKJV) ***“Jesus said to him, “If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes.”***

God’s plan here included more than giving Israel a piece of real estate! God’s desire

was to bring Israel to a place of confidence in Jehovah that they would doubt nothing!

Unbelief or lack of confidence kept an entire generation of Jews out of Canaan's land!

Bad attitudes = Bad outcomes!

A generation of Israelites being kept out of the Promised Land was such an unnecessary thing because Jehovah was willing and able to deliver them! Listen to what a response to a bad attitude sounds like! Numbers 14:1-5 (NKJV) ***“So all the congregation lifted up their voices and cried, and the people wept that night. ² And all the children of Israel complained against Moses and Aaron, and the whole congregation said to them, “If only we had died in the land of Egypt! Or if only we had died in this wilderness! ³ Why has the LORD brought us to this land to fall by the sword, that our wives and children should become victims? Would it not be better for us to return to Egypt?” ⁴ So they***

said to one another, “Let us select a leader and return to Egypt.”⁵ Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel.” Bad attitudes = bad outcomes!

Listen to what an attitude of confidence sounds like in the face of doubt and unbelief! Numbers 14:6-9 (NKJV) *“But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were among those who had spied out the land, tore their clothes;⁷ and they spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying: “The land we passed through to spy out is an exceedingly good land.”⁸ If the LORD delights in us, then He will bring us into this land and give it to us, ‘a land which flows with milk and honey.’⁹ Only do not rebel against the LORD, nor fear the people of the land, for they are our bread; their protection has departed from them, and the LORD is with*

us. Do not fear them.” In this Scripture, Caleb and Joshua exude confidence in God and Israel concerning their ability to perform the tasks God was calling them to do. Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

David said, Psalm 60:12 (NKJV) ***“Through God we will do valiantly, For it is He who shall tread down our enemies.”***

When we assimilate the characteristics into our lives that Caleb assimilated, victory will always follow! Psalm 91:1-16 (NKJV) ***“He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High Shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty. ² I will say of the LORD, “He is my refuge and my fortress; My God, in Him I will trust.” ³ Surely He shall deliver you from the snare of the fowler And from the perilous pestilence. ⁴ He shall cover you with His feathers, And under His wings you shall take refuge; His truth shall be your shield and buckler. ⁵ You shall not be***

*afraid of the terror by night, Nor of the
arrow that flies by day, ⁶ Nor of the
pestilence that walks in darkness, Nor of
the destruction that lays waste at noonday.
⁷ A thousand may fall at your side, And ten
thousand at your right hand; But it shall
not come near you. ⁸ Only with your eyes
shall you look, And see the reward of the
wicked. ⁹ Because you have made the LORD,
who is my refuge, Even the Most High,
your dwelling place, ¹⁰ No evil shall befall
you, Nor shall any plague come near your
dwelling; ¹¹ For He shall give His angels
charge over you, To keep you in all your
ways. ¹² In their hands they shall bear you
up, Lest you dash your foot against a stone.
¹³ You shall tread upon the lion and the
cobra, The young lion and the serpent you
shall trample underfoot. ¹⁴ “Because he has
set his love upon Me, therefore I will
deliver him; I will set him on high, because
he has known My name. ¹⁵ He shall call
upon Me, and I will answer him; I will be*

with him in trouble; I will deliver him and honor him. ¹⁶ With long life I will satisfy him, And show him My salvation.”

Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

IV. CALEB EXHIBITED AN ATTITUDE OF CONVICTION...

An opinion isn't worth anything; a conviction is something one would be willing to die for!

Hebrew word Caleb (KAW-LABE) means “*Forcible fortitude!*” (Cereal is fortified with 10 essential vitamins) (Woman and husband who went to heaven 10 years too late – ate their oat bran)

The English definition is, “*possessor of the promise.*”

Caleb had been across Jordan and while there he had gone to Mt. Hebron, which is

the place of Death. Something began to stir in his spirit as he realized that this is the place where Abraham, Sarah, Isaac, Jacob, and some of the patriarchs are buried! In years to come this would be the place where David's kingdom would be initiated!

Caleb decided that this was his mountain!
Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Caleb's attitude of conviction lasted for more than forty years and produced an inheritance in his life! Joshua 14:6-13 (NKJV) *"Then the children of Judah came to Joshua in Gilgal. And Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him: "You know the word which the LORD said to Moses the man of God concerning you and me in Kadesh Barnea. ⁷ I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to spy out the land, and I brought back word to him as it was in my heart. ⁸ Nevertheless my*

brethren who went up with me made the heart of the people melt, but I wholly followed the LORD my God. ⁹ So Moses swore on that day, saying, ‘Surely the land where your foot has trodden shall be your inheritance and your children’s forever, because you have wholly followed the LORD my God.’ ¹⁰ And now, behold, the LORD has kept me alive, as He said, these forty-five years, ever since the LORD spoke this word to Moses while Israel wandered in the wilderness; and now, here I am this day, eighty-five years old. ¹¹ As yet I am as strong this day as on the day that Moses sent me; just as my strength was then, so now is my strength for war, both for going out and for coming in. ¹² Now therefore, give me this mountain of which the LORD spoke in that day; for you heard in that day how the Anakim were there, and that the cities were great and fortified. It may be that the LORD will be with me, and I shall be able to drive them out as the LORD

said.”¹³ ***And Joshua blessed him, and gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh as an inheritance.***” Notice the lack of criticism here! Good attitudes = Great outcomes! (Sis Emma Sullivan – *“I just want the devil to know whose side I’m on!”*) Good attitudes = Great outcomes!

Caleb says give me this mountain of Death to sin and self! This kind of conviction is what it takes to live a victorious Christian life.

CONCLUSION: Let’s get up and move forward, and possess the Land!

God is looking for a group of people who want to have a right spirit!